

TRADING NOTES ANALYSIS

What Was Your Team's Decision-Making Process?

The purpose of this deliverable is to demonstrate how your team's investment decisions reflected the strategy it developed for the client, including its approach to growth, risk, liquidity, funding reliability, financial flexibility, and future cash-flow needs.

Successful investing is not simply about selecting individual stocks. It requires making disciplined decisions that consistently support an overall investment strategy. Throughout the competition, your Trading Notes should document the research, analysis, and reasoning behind your investment decisions. Collectively, they provide evidence of how your team has put its strategy into practice.

For this analysis, select three investment decisions that best illustrate your team's strategic thinking. Explain the reasoning behind each decision, how it aligned with, tested, or refined your overall investment strategy, and how it supported the client's goals, funding needs, or risk considerations.

Collectively, the decisions should demonstrate how your team used individual investments as part of a cohesive portfolio strategy. The focus should be on the quality of your reasoning and the intended role of each decision, not simply whether an investment gained or lost value during the competition.

Your team will formally present its investment strategy in the Investment Policy Statement (IPS) in Week 6. Although your strategy may continue to evolve as you conduct additional research and evaluate new information, you should already be using a clear strategic approach to guide your investment decisions.

At this stage, your team is not expected to calculate the final size of the operating reserve, complete long-term portfolio projections, determine Laura's facility contribution, or draft her communication to co-sponsors. These recommendations will be developed in the Final Report. The Trading Notes Analysis should focus on your investment decisions and their relationship with your developing strategy.

Important

The Trading Notes you select do not need to correspond to investments that remain in your portfolio at the end of the competition. A decision can still demonstrate thoughtful analysis and strategic thinking even if your team later sells the investment or changes its approach.

What matters is that each Trading Note provides evidence of your team's decision-making process. Your reflections should clearly explain how each decision supported, tested, or refined your overall investment strategy. The analysis should be consistent with the strategic approach your team is developing and will later articulate in its IPS.

Trading Note Example

We are purchasing shares of an intermediate-term U.S. Treasury bond ETF to reduce portfolio volatility and begin preparing for Laura's future operating commitment. The position provides income and greater stability than equities, although interest-rate changes may affect its value. This trade supports our plan to balance continued growth with reliable future cash flows as the residency funding date approaches.

Instructions

- Select three (3) Trading Notes from trades your team executed in WInS.
- Include each Trading Note exactly as it appears in WInS.
- For **EACH** Trading Note, write a reflection of 100 words or fewer explaining:
 - Why your team made the investment decision.
 - How the decision aligned with your overall investment strategy.
 - How the decision supported the client's goals, funding needs, or risk considerations.

The Trading Notes must correspond to trades executed in WInS. Yes, we will verify this.

Your team will submit their trading notes via the SurveyMonkey Apply form.